# HENRIK MARTIN SAUER

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## EDUCATION

**PhD Economics** *2023 - Present*
University of Mannheim, Germany
Essays on Financial and Competition Economics

**MRes Economics** *2021 - 2023*
University of Mannheim, Germany

**MSc Economics** *2020 - 2021*
London School of Economics and Political Science, United Kingdom

**BSc Economics** *2017 - 2020*
University of Mannheim, Germany

**Visiting Student** *2019*
University of Warwick, United Kingdom

## INTERESTS

Financial Economics, Corporate Finance
Microeconomic Theory, Mechanism Design, Industrial Organisation

## RESEARCH

**Public markets for securitized litigation assets** *(with Julian Klix and Paul Wegener)*
We study how public pricing in litigation finance markets affects plaintiffs' financing decisions and settlement bargaining. A plaintiff sells shares of case proceeds via an intermediary platform whose price reveals case quality. Settlement is modeled as a one-sided private information game in which the defendant makes offers. We show that plaintiffs optimally oversell their claims relative to efficient risk sharing. Reduced risk exposure enables credible commitment to tougher settlement demands, and bargaining gains exceed the per-share price discount. More informative prices temper this overselling, as information substitutes for issuance in strengthening the plaintiff's bargaining position. The welfare implications of public prices are nevertheless ambiguous. Better information improves the allocation of risk but sends more disputes to trial. Endogenizing the mass of investors may further reinforce overselling.

**Hedge fund trading around shareholder votes on mergers: A common ownership perspective**
Recent theories on shareholder democracy predict that shareholders reallocate based on their preferences for the expected outcome of the vote. I extend these theories by incorporating common ownership. I predict that when shareholders benefit from a merger through their positions in industry competitors, they increase their ownership of the acquirer, and vice versa. To test my predictions, I study hedge fund trading in acquirers for mergers requiring shareholder approval. Hedge funds indeed increase their acquirer ownership by 0.6 pp per $100M in combined abnormal returns to horizontal competitors. With shareholder reallocation driven by cross-holdings, shareholder approval becomes disconnected from the acquirer's gains from the merger. Moreover, approval voting and announcement returns become systematically less informative to competition authorities.

**Loss-Portfolio-Tranfers in Reinsurance Markets**
Work in progress

## ADVISORS

**Volker Nocke**
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
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**Ernst Maug**
University of Mannheim
Department of Finance
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## TEACHING

Economic Policy - 2023, 2025, 2026 (Undergraduate)
Principles of Economics - 2024 (Undergraduate)
Statistics I - 2019 (Undergraduate)
Analysis and Linear Algebra A - 2018 (Undergraduate)

## POSITIONS

**European Central Bank** *11/2026 - Present*
PhD Trainee - Market-based Finance Division

**Collaborative Research Center 224** *07/2024 - Present*
Project Member, B03: Consumer Protection and Competition Policy

**NERA Economic Consulting** *06/2022 - 09/2022*
Analyst Intern – Antitrust and Competition Economics, Berlin, Germany

## CONFERENCES

**2026**
MaCCI IO Day Mannheim, BCFM PhD Conference Cologne, EEA Dublin, EALE Conference

**2025**
ENTER Jamboree Stockholm, CRC 224 Young Researchers Workshop Offenbach

## MISCELLANEOUS

**Awards & Fellowships**
Studienstiftung des Deutschen Volkes (Merit-based: top 0.5% of students), 2021
Deutschlandstipendium (Merit-based: top 1.5% of students), 2020

**Programming & Tools**
Languages: Python (pandas, numpy, rapidfuzz, statsmodels), Stata, R, Excel, Mathematica, LaTeX

**Languages**
German (Native), English (C2), Spanish (B2), Latin

**Societal Engagement**
Actor - ATG Mannheim e.V. (Co-Founder) in 2017-2019 and University Theater in 2023-2024